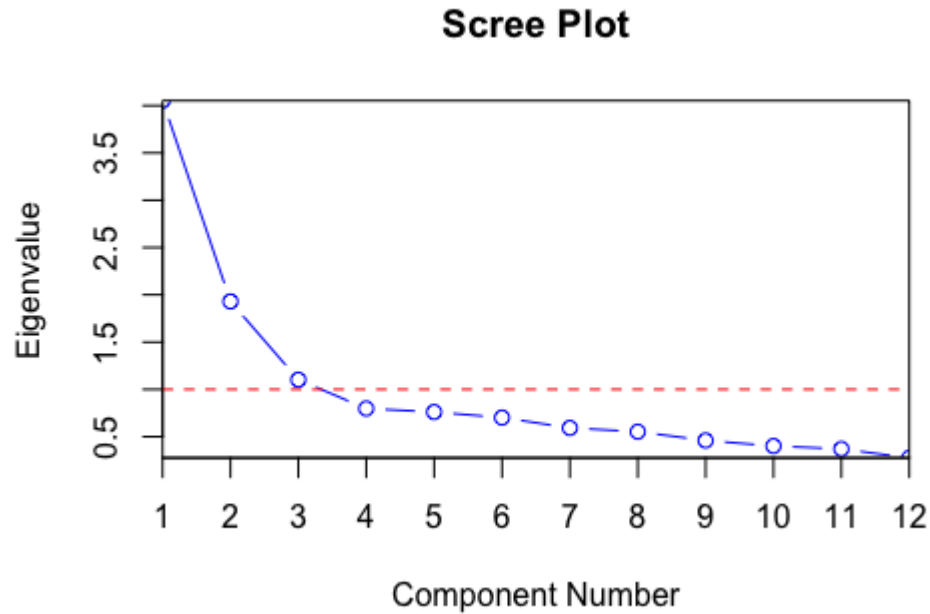


Scree Plot

We examine the scree plot to decide on the number of principal components required to visualize the data.



We choose the smallest number of principal components that are required in order to explain a sizable amount of the variability in the data

This is done by eyeballing the scree plot and looking for a point at which the proportion of variance explained by each subsequent principal component drops off. This drop is often referred to as an elbow in the scree plot.